

Veterans Backbone – Privacy & Data Framework

Purpose

People should understand what information is collected, why it is collected, how it is used, and how it is protected.

This framework establishes the principles that guide information handling throughout Veterans Backbone.

Information exists to support people, services, safeguarding, accountability, and organisational learning.

It does not exist for curiosity, convenience, or commercial exploitation.

Core Principle 1 – People Before Paperwork

Information should serve a purpose.

We only collect information that is genuinely needed to support individuals, deliver services, meet legal responsibilities, or keep people safe.

Core Principle 2 – Respect For Privacy

People have a right to privacy, dignity, and appropriate confidentiality.

Information should be handled respectfully and shared only when necessary.

Core Principle 3 – Safety Matters Too

Privacy is important.

So is safeguarding.

Where there is a genuine risk of harm, information may need to be shared in order to protect people.

Safety takes precedence where risk exists.

Core Principle 4 – Transparency

People should understand:

- What information is collected
- Why it is collected
- How it is used
- Who can access it
- How long it is retained

Hidden processes undermine trust.

Core Principle 5 – Access On A Need-To-Know Basis

Access to information should be limited to individuals who genuinely require it to perform their role or fulfil legal obligations.

Curiosity is not a legitimate reason to access information.

Core Principle 6 – Security & Accountability

Information must be stored securely and managed responsibly.

Everyone handling information shares responsibility for protecting it.

Core Principle 7 – Human Accountability

Systems support information management.

People remain accountable for decisions, access, handling, and information sharing.

Responsibility cannot be delegated to software.

Core Principle 8 – Learning Without Exploitation

Data may be used to understand trends, improve services, and evaluate outcomes.

People are not statistics.

Information should never be used in ways that compromise dignity or trust.

Final Statement

Privacy and accountability are not opposing forces.

Veterans Backbone seeks to protect both.

Information should be handled carefully, used responsibly, and shared only when there is a legitimate reason to do so.